

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | SIEM Engineering | Detection Capability | Security Monitoring Automation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, cyber detection capability development and the automation of security monitoring across large-scale enterprise environments. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I design, deploy and manage data source feeds and detection content within the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platform, developing Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and automated playbooks that underpin the institution's Cyber Security Operations Centre (CSOC) function. I have extensive experience managing Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) security tooling and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate. I am skilled in incident response, alert triage and threat hunting, and I have a strong track record of improving the automation of security monitoring and building detection capability aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. Having worked across education and public sector organisations, I understand the governance requirements and stakeholder expectations of mission-critical, nationally significant environments such as the NHS health and care system.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, data source feed onboarding, analytics rule development, detection content management
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced KQL query authoring, scheduled analytics rules, custom workbooks and automated reporting dashboards
- **Security Monitoring Automation:** Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development in Microsoft Sentinel and Logic Apps, automated alert enrichment and response workflows
- **Cyber Detection Capability:** Detection engineering, threat-led detection design, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, detection gap analysis
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, Defender for Cloud
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response procedures, alert triage and escalation, root cause analysis, forensic investigation support
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based hunts across endpoint, identity and cloud telemetry
- **Identity Security:** Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), endpoint alert management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM implementation and administration
- **Compliance and Governance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting and workflow automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Design, deploy and manage SIEM data source feeds and detection content within Microsoft Sentinel, onboarding new data sources from cloud, endpoint, identity and network infrastructure to improve

monitoring coverage

- Develop and maintain KQL analytics rules, detection content and automated workbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, building and continuously improving the cyber detection capability for UAL's CSOC function
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and Logic Apps, improving the automation of security monitoring and reducing manual analyst effort
- Administer and engineer the CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside the Microsoft Sentinel platform, ensuring comprehensive telemetry coverage across an 8,000-user estate
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and M365 Defender, configuring detection rules, monitoring alerts and leading incident response activities
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across endpoint, identity and cloud telemetry using KQL and MITRE ATT&CK-mapped techniques, translating hunting findings into new detection rules
- Lead security incident response activities in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating investigation, containment, eradication and recovery across cross-functional teams
- Manage vulnerability scanning and remediation using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentra BAS, reporting findings to management and tracking remediation to closure

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Monitored security alerts and telemetry across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon and MDE, triaging, investigating and responding to security events in line with NIST 800-61 incident response procedures
- Contributed to the development of KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, supporting the build-out of the institution's cyber detection capability
- Developed automated enrichment and response workflows in Microsoft Sentinel SOAR, reducing manual analyst triage effort and improving consistency of response
- Conducted regular threat hunting exercises using KQL and the MITRE ATT&CK framework, identifying indicators of compromise and improving detection coverage
- Managed MFA, SSO and Conditional Access policies in Azure AD and Entra ID, maintaining identity security controls across the 8,000-user estate
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Nessus and AppCheck, generating reports and tracking remediation activities to closure
- Assisted with BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) administration, onboarding privileged accounts and maintaining compliance with audit and governance requirements

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service/FinTech)

- Monitored security alerts and investigated incidents across endpoint, identity and cloud infrastructure, documenting findings and contributing to improvement of the security monitoring capability
- Implemented and maintained security controls including endpoint security, identity and access management (IAM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO)
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and supported remediation of identified security weaknesses, contributing to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities
- Contributed to the development of security processes, runbooks and documentation to support operational consistency and governance requirements

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a comprehensive SIEM detection content library within Microsoft Sentinel, significantly improving the cyber detection capability for UAL's CSOC and reducing false-positive alert volumes through tuned KQL analytics rules
- Built and automated over 15 SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and Logic Apps, improving the automation of security monitoring and reducing mean time to respond for common alert categories
- Onboarded multiple new data source feeds into Microsoft Sentinel from endpoint, identity, cloud and network infrastructure, expanding monitoring coverage across previously unmonitored assets

- Engineered CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM deployment across an 8,000-user estate, consolidating endpoint telemetry and improving threat hunting and detection capability
- Led threat hunting programmes using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped techniques and KQL, translating hunting findings into new detection rules and contributing to continuous improvement of detection coverage
- Deployed and managed Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to validate the effectiveness of SIEM detection rules against real attack techniques, closing detection gaps identified through simulation

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Leeds/Exeter/London, UK)